

John Adams by David McCullough - Summary

John Adams by David McCullough is a biography of America's second president, John Adams. The book follows his life from lawyer and patriot to diplomat, vice president, and president. It shows Adams as intelligent, honest, hardworking, and sometimes stubborn.

Main Ideas:

- **Fight for Independence:** Adams strongly supported American independence from Britain.
- **Public Service:** He worked tirelessly in Congress and helped shape the new nation.
- **Diplomacy:** Adams served abroad in Europe and helped secure support for America.
- **Presidency:** As president, he faced conflict with France and deep political division.
- **Family Support:** His wife Abigail Adams was an important advisor and partner.
- **Character:** The book highlights duty, integrity, sacrifice, and perseverance.

Overall Message:

The biography presents John Adams as a principled leader who played a major role in founding the United States, even if he was less celebrated than some of his peers.